

# Skills Summary

## Numerals, Number Words, and How Many

*Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.*

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**One number, three ways.** The **picture** shows the things, the **numeral** is the sign you write, and the **number word** is what you say. They all name the same amount.

**The how-many rule:** touch each thing once, and the *last number you say* is how many there are.

**Frames are shortcuts:** a full five-frame is 5 and a full ten-frame is 10, so start there and count on instead of counting from one.

### 1. Count a picture and write the numeral

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Count the full frame first, then count *on* for the loose things — do not go back to one. Then write the last number you said as a numeral.

**Example:** A full five-frame and 3 loose dots. How many?

**Step 1.** The frame is full, so it already shows five — start there instead of counting it again.

**Step 2.** Count on for the loose dots: “six, seven, eight”. That is  $5 + 3$ .

The numeral is **8**.

**Try it:** A full five-frame and 2 loose dots. Write the numeral.

check: 7

### 2. Match a number word to its numeral

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Teen words are “ten and some more”: *eleven* is ten and one, *twelve* is ten and two, *thirteen* is ten and three.

Write the ten first, then the extras — so *thirteen* is 13, never 31. A full ten-frame beside the loose counters shows you which way round it goes.

**Example:** The word card says *eleven*. What numeral is that?

**Step 1.** Teen words name a ten and some more, so build eleven out of a full ten-frame plus the extras.

**Step 2.** A full ten-frame is 10; count on for the one extra counter: “eleven”. That is  $10 + 1$ .

The numeral is **11**.

**Try it:** The word card says *thirteen*. Write the numeral.

check: 13

### 3. Compare two amounts shown in different ways

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Turn *both* cards into numbers first — count a picture, read a word, keep a numeral as it is. Only then compare.

$>$  means *is greater than* and  $<$  means *is less than*. The open end of the sign always faces the bigger number.

**Example:** One card shows 4 dots and 2 more. The other shows 4 dots and 4 more. Which is less?

**Step 1.** Nothing can be compared until each card is one number, so finish both counts first.

**Step 2.** First card:  $4 + 2$ , which is six. Second card:  $4 + 4$ , which is eight. Six is less than eight.

First card  $<$  second card.

**Try it:** One card shows 5 dots and 3 more; the other shows 5 dots and 1 more. Write  $>$  or  $<$  between them.

$<$  check

**(!) Watch out:** a set that takes up more space is not always more — only the count decides. And when someone asks “how many?” after you have counted, say the last number again instead of counting the whole set over.